

The Brutal Truth About Becoming a Man You Respect

Channel: Brandon Carter · Published: Sep 04, 2026 · Watch: <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=z0qoG0LYyXw> Source: full transcript

Executive Summary

Home builder and entrepreneur Brock Hulio (47) and trainer Brandon Carter (44) discuss staying fit as a busy older man, why consistency beats motivation, the danger of going through the motions, and how radical self-accountability is the only path to becoming a man you respect.

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Guest Introduction: Brock Hulio's Background 0:00

- Brock Hulio is a real estate developer and home builder with roughly **15 years** of home building experience; licensed around 2003–2004
 - Did concrete construction before transitioning to home building
- Survived the **2008–2009 financial crash**: business went to nearly nothing
 - Moved to North Dakota alone, leaving his wife and child in Utah
 - Lived in a **metal storage unit** for 5–6 months, essentially homeless
 - Made enough money to return, restart, and reunite with his family
 - "Takes what it takes."

- Now approaching **47 years old**; Brandon Carter is turning **44**

Staying in Shape as a Busy, Older Man 1:35

- Brock has been training for **30 years**, which means he needs less gym time than a beginner trying to build mass
 - Can complete most workouts in **30–40 minutes**; leg days or heavier sessions run about **45 minutes**
- Follows an **old-school bro split**: one muscle group per day (legs, arms, etc.)
- Getting lean is a newer look for him — previously did more strongman training where carrying extra body fat was functional
- **HIIT cardio preference over steady state:**
 - Brock finds that steady state (e.g., an hour on the treadmill) tightens his lower back, glutes, and hamstrings due to years of construction injuries
 - A 25-minute HIIT session with multi-functional movements actually **opens everything up** — he finishes feeling looser, not stiffer
 - Brandon is the opposite: prefers steady state as he ages because HIIT caused injuries for him
 - Key takeaway: **find what works for your body** — there's no single answer
- Leaves his phone in his truck during every gym session
 - "This is 45 minutes of me just being here."
 - Brandon keeps his in his bag on Do Not Disturb: "If it can't wait 30 minutes, call the police, not me."

Brock's HIIT Cardio Workout & the NewFit App 4:15

- Launching a fitness app called **NewFit** (website: **newfit.me**); free download, **\$0.99/month** after a 30-day free period
- **Workout structure:**
 - Warm-up: ~5–6 minutes, 4–5 exercises done for **20 seconds each**, repeated; no rest between exercises in the warm-up
 - Main workout: 4–5 exercises done by **reps** (not timed intervals)
 - Example exercises: Spider-Man push-ups (20 reps), burpees (10 reps), mountain climbers (30 reps), squat jumps (10 reps)
 - Complete all exercises as a circuit straight through
 - Rest **30–45 seconds** between circuits
 - Each circuit takes Brock ~**1 min 45 sec to 2 minutes** to complete
 - Total session: approximately **25 minutes**
 - 3–4 different workout options to choose from
- **Design philosophy:** as simple as possible; designed to be hard enough that unconditioned users won't finish it at first

- **Presentation:** animated/cartoon format so it appeals to younger generations — workouts filmed at Brock's pace and then cartoonified, "almost like a video game-esque workout routine"
 - Eliminates the excuse of needing equipment (bodyweight only, can be done from a living room)
 - "I've taken all the excuses out of getting in shape. It's 25 minutes — less time than an episode of SpongeBob."

Fitness as the Fastest Needle to Move 7:35

- Compared to business (where going from 7 to 8 figures can take **several years**), fitness results come fast
 - Can see **4–5 lbs of weight loss every couple of weeks** with consistent effort
- The three things required — distilled to their simplest form:
 - Eat better
 - Move more
 - Be consistent
- Consistency threshold: **less than 1% of the population can do two things consistently for 100 days**
 - "If I eat better and move more for 100 days, I'm doing something 99% of the population can't do — that puts me in the top 1%."
- Physical consistency builds mental and emotional resilience: "You're forging this will of: I can do hard shit."
- The confidence loop:
 - Competence → Confidence → Confirmation that what you're doing works → Motivation to continue
 - Motivation does NOT come first; it's a byproduct of doing the work
- Brandon's personal testimony: started lifting in high school, it pulled him out of depression, changed his personality, other kids asked him to teach them → became a trainer
 - "It builds a real confidence — not fake bravado — a confidence you can actually trust."

Where the Drive Comes From When You Already Have Everything 11:30

- Brandon notes that married men with money are typically the **hardest to train** — they lose incentive
- Brock's answer: **"I'm completely satisfied with never being satisfied."**
- Doesn't care about the view from the top — loves the climb
 - "The middle is the least boring part — that's where all the fucked-up shit happens."
 - After 30 years in construction, still occasionally blindsided by something he never could have anticipated — and he views this as exciting, not defeating
- Physical appearance as self-respect:
 - "You can be wealthy, put on a \$10,000 suit and still look like a bucket of shit."
 - "If you can pull off \$12 Walmart jeans and a \$3 t-shirt and make that look good — that guy can put on a \$300 suit and make it look like a \$10,000 suit."
 - "The man makes the clothes, not the other way around."

- Brandon's parallel motivation: "I'm not trying to see how much I can get away with. I'm trying to see how much I can push myself — what percentage of my potential can I bring to the surface?"

"I don't want to die with all this unfulfilled potential on me." — Brandon Carter

Repetition vs. Optimization: Stop Going Through the Motions 19:47

- People confuse **repetition** (just showing up) with **optimization** (doing the work with purpose)
- The gym example: regulars who've been there for a decade and never change
 - They take selfies on the squat rack, scroll for playlists, chat with anyone who'll listen — doing everything possible to avoid the actual work
 - "They're going through the motions."
- The same half-assing pattern bleeds into every area of life:
 - At work: does just enough to not get fired, never enough to get noticed or promoted
 - At home: kid comes to share something — dad doesn't look up from his phone; wife asks a question — half-engaged, still watching TikTok
 - "You've got a beautiful wife you chose to have kids with and you're going to come home and ignore them?"
- The fix: **be engaged, be present, go all in** — in the gym, at work, with your family
 - "15 minutes of dialed-in focused attention with your kid is better than 3.5 hours of just kind of being there."
- Brock leaves his phone in his truck; Brandon puts his on Do Not Disturb and uses it only for audio

Acting with Intent and Mental Rehearsal 24:15

- Think through problems completely before acting — "you should have built those stairs in your head five times before you actually build them"
- Pre-visualize workouts before going to the gym:
 - Know exactly which exercises you're doing (e.g., squats, hack squats, deadlifts)
 - "I've done them in my head before I even go. I've painted a picture of me doing that workout."
- Carry yourself with purpose and intent everywhere
 - Walk in knowing what you're there to do; don't bumble around, don't lack spatial awareness
 - "Act like you belong."
- Everything you do should be focused — unfocused effort in one area signals unfocused effort everywhere

Language, Accountability, and Eliminating "Try" 26:07

- Language reveals hidden avoidance — people hide behind words
- **Eliminate the word "try"** from your vocabulary entirely

- Brock: "I would rather slam my dick in a sliding glass door than have somebody tell me they're trying to do something."
- Brandon calls people who use it "try babies" and bans the word in his coaching program
- The only acceptable context: "I'm going to do this or die trying."
- Compare the two framings:

Weak ("try")	Strong (intent)
I'm going to try to go to bed at 9:00	I'm going to bed at 9:00
I'm going to try to wake up at 5:00	I'm waking up at 5:00
I'm going to try to go to the gym	I'm going to the gym

- "Which of the two do you think actually got the job done? Who would you bet on?"

Personal Responsibility vs. Outsourcing Your Life 27:17

- Brock's critique of "God has a plan for you" as a mindset at conferences:
 - Takes all control away from the person and places it on an external force
 - "You have to be your own savior."
- Core argument: money, houses, cars, jewelry — these are **man-made games**; God didn't create them and therefore has no stake in whether you win or lose at them
 - "If this matters to you, you have to do it yourself."
- The more you point fingers inward — "It's my job. It's my fault. Nobody's coming. I've got to fix this." — the more power you actually have
- Brandon adds: all his goals feel like first-world problems; it seems almost presumptuous to pray for more when others are in war zones or starving
 - "God's busy with the real shit."
- Both agree: God (if he cares about anything) likely cares about **your character**, not your possessions
 - "What did you build? Not what tangible assets, but who did you build yourself into?"
 - "Did you build yourself into a warrior that can slay dragons, or did you just piddle-dick around and piss your life away?"

"Maybe God's plan was just: he gave you life, and you're supposed to figure the fuck out." — Brock Hulio

Self-Humility, Social Media, and the Highlight Reel Trap 36:19

- We've lost **self-humility** — the ability to laugh at ourselves
 - Everyone does dumb stuff; owning it and laughing at it is healthy

- Social media makes people play it cautious — everything is documented, so people only show the glamorous side
- The highlight reel problem:
 - People see vacations, new cars, new boats — and assume that person's life is perfect
 - Reality: some are spending money they don't have to impress people they don't like
 - Even if they genuinely have the money: "Nobody's life is an unbroken boulevard of green lights."
 - Nobody posts themselves crying; everyone compares their full behind-the-scenes to someone else's curated highlight reel
- Fix: stop comparing. "He's them. You're you."
 - If you want what they have and you're not there yet, focus on what you can do to get there — lock in, go all in, optimize
- Trust fund billionaires example: they never learned to become valuable — only to spend
 - "They get into drugs because the dopamine runs out. There's only so much dopamine."
 - Eternal bliss with no challenges is actually undesirable: "I want the dragons to slay. I want the mountains to climb."



Playing the Hand You're Dealt [38:57](#)

- "Everybody's been dealt a shit hand. You can either play the hand you've been dealt or you can complain about it."
- Even if someone else had more advantages or an easier path — if you want what they have, work harder than them
 - Their circumstances don't influence your life; you deal with your reality
- Envy of easy money misses the point: people who inherited wealth often find it meaningless
 - "I have no value other than spending money I never made."
- Brock's personal drive: addicted to chaos, mayhem, and challenge — doesn't want eternal contentment, wants more mountains to climb



How to Build Drive When You Don't Have It [40:33](#)

- Drive is **not innate — it is built**
 - "You're not born with it. You have to build it."
- **Start with fitness** — it's the fastest win and builds the confidence foundation everything else stacks on
- Daily self-audit: Brock talks to himself in his truck **2–3 times a day**, asking honest questions:
 - Were you the best version of yourself today?
 - Did you get the work done that needed to get done?
 - Did you eat right, or did you fuck off and eat a cupcake?
 - Were you short or unkind to your wife — and if so, own it?

- The self-trust problem:
 - You trust a stranger Uber driver to get you home safely; you trust a carnival ride operator who "probably hasn't bathed since the '90s"
 - Yet the one person you won't trust is yourself — and that's actually rational, because **you have lied to yourself more than anyone else ever has**
- How to rebuild self-trust:
 - Start keeping small promises to yourself, one by one
 - "I'm going to bed at 9. I'm waking up at 5. I'm hitting the gym." — little wins stack
 - Eventually you feel confident trusting yourself again
- The mirror moment: "Look in the mirror and say: that's the fucker that's been fucking me this whole time. That's the guy causing all the problems — but that's also the guy who can fix it. So let's get to work."
 - "He's the only guy who can fix it."

Treating People Right: Practical and Moral Reasons 33:20

- People with genuine confidence and quiet toughness tend to treat others decently
 - It's those with **low self-esteem** who call people out, start fights, and bully — the online influencer who challenges everyone is actually an insecure person
- Brock's standard: treat the billionaire the same as the 7-Eleven clerk
 - "I'll treat that person with the same respect as the person at 7-Eleven."
 - Brandon: treats janitors and valets in his building with the same respect as executives
- Practical argument — even if you don't care about being a good person:
 - You never know what someone will become or what position they'll be in 20 years from now
 - Brandon's personal story: someone was unkind to him in his early 20s; 20 years later, Brandon was in a position to help that person significantly (a referral/recommendation)
 - He was honest with his contact: "I met this person 20 years ago and they were kind of a jerk."
 - That person didn't get the opportunity — it would have really helped them
 - "Just on a practical level, you don't know who these people are going to become."
- What we're missing most: **self-humility** — the ability to be honest about being an idiot sometimes and laugh at yourself for it

Brock's Book, App, and Where to Find Him 45:18

- **Book:** *Build the Fuck* — targeting an **October launch**
 - A cautionary tale told through the same man taking two different paths
 - Setting: a man in his mid-to-late 80s sitting alone in a dark room, reflecting on his life
 - Path 1: Stories of crashes, burns, successes, heartbreak, triumphs — a has-been with a life fully lived

- Path 2: A pool of regret — all the "woulda, coulda, shouldas" — "I'm not even a has-been. I'm a fucking never was."
- "The most horrible death I could think of: 'What did you do with your life? You pissed it away. Why? Because I was scared somebody was going to laugh at me on social media.'"
- Website: brockhulio.com (all resources on one page)
- **Fitness App:** NewFit
 - Website: newfit.me
 - Free download; **\$0.99/month** after 30-day trial
 - No equipment needed, 25 minutes, can be done from your living room
 - "I've eliminated all the excuses anyone can have around getting in shape."
- Also appearing on other podcasts including content with **Brad Lee**